

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Defender XDR | SIEM/SOAR Engineering

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniproper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Microsoft Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, deploying, and managing Microsoft security solutions at enterprise scale. My expertise centres on Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), including data connector onboarding, custom log parsing and normalisation, Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rule engineering, Logic Apps automation, and dashboard and reporting pipeline development for incident trends and rule performance. I also have deep hands-on experience across Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO), and the broader Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR) stack. At the University of the Arts London I safeguard the digital environment for over 8,000 users, delivering advanced threat detection, automated response, and continuous improvement of the security monitoring platform. I am seeking a senior engineering role at a managed security services organisation where I can apply Microsoft security expertise to protect clients' environments and drive innovation in detection and response capabilities.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM/SOAR):** data connector onboarding; custom log parsing via Data Collection Rules and custom tables; KQL analytics rule development; Logic Apps automation playbooks; incident management workflows; dashboards and reporting pipelines for incident trends and rule performance
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO); Microsoft 365 Defender advanced hunting; cross-workload incident correlation
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** NG-SIEM; EDR Prevent; Insight threat hunting; Discover asset intelligence; Fusion SOAR automation - expert level
- **Identity and Access:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory); Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO); Privileged Identity Management (PIM); BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK framework-aligned rule development; detection logic tuning and optimisation; threat hunting hypothesis development; alert prioritisation and false positive reduction
- **SOAR and Automation:** Logic Apps; Microsoft Sentinel playbooks; CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR; PowerShell scripting; automated alert enrichment and triage workflows
- **Vulnerability and Compliance:** Tenable.io; AppCheck; Nessus; Pentera BAS; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials Plus; NIST CSF; CIS Controls
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Design, deploy, and manage Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM/SOAR platform for an 8,000-user enterprise: configure data connectors for Microsoft 365, Azure, Entra ID, endpoint, and third-party sources; develop custom tables and parsing logic for non-standard log formats; build KQL analytics rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs).
- Develop and maintain Logic Apps automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel: automate alert enrichment, ticket creation, containment actions, and stakeholder notifications; reduce mean time to respond (MTTR) through automated first-response workflows.
- Build dashboards and reporting pipelines in Microsoft Sentinel covering incident trends, rule performance, false positive rates, and mean time to detect (MTTD) metrics; produce weekly and monthly management

reports for senior IT leadership and the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO).

- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO) across the full M365 environment: configure policies, perform advanced hunting in Microsoft 365 Defender, tune alerts, and manage incident lifecycle from detection through containment and eradication.
- Safeguard the organisation's digital environment by designing and implementing detection use cases that correlate signals across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud workloads; validate detections through Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and adversary simulation exercises.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon platform including NG-SIEM ingestion, EDR Prevent policy configuration, Insight threat hunting modules, and Discover asset inventory; integrate CrowdStrike telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for cross-platform correlation.
- Engineer CrowdStrike Fusion SOAR playbooks to automate routine detection and response workflows; develop automated containment actions for high-confidence detections to reduce analyst dwell time.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID including Conditional Access policy management, MFA enforcement, SSO integrations, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM); maintain Zero Trust identity posture aligned to Microsoft Security Benchmark.
- Lead security incident response in accordance with NIST SP 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK: manage the full incident lifecycle, conduct post-incident reviews, and use findings to improve detection logic and SOAR playbooks.
- Manage Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) environment; enforce compliance baselines, manage conditional access integration, and support device lifecycle management.
- Drive vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS; track remediation progress and report security posture metrics to senior stakeholders.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Delivered Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions including alert triage, investigation, and incident escalation using Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon for an 8,000-user environment.
- Developed KQL analytics rules and detection content in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK; tuned existing rules to reduce false positives and improve detection fidelity; maintained detection rule library with version control and change documentation.
- Conducted threat hunting in Microsoft Sentinel advanced hunting and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight; developed hunting hypotheses based on threat intelligence and TTP analysis; documented findings and converted confirmed threats into scheduled analytics rules.
- Managed data connector onboarding for new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel; parsed and normalised log formats using Data Collection Rules, KQL transformation queries, and custom table schemas.
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO): managed policies, reviewed incidents, tuned alerts, and supported advanced hunting investigations.
- Maintained Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) Conditional Access policies, MFA configurations, and SSO integrations; managed Privileged Identity Management (PIM) just-in-time access workflows.
- Supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance; maintained Sentinel workspace governance and SIEM health monitoring.
- Ran vulnerability scans using Tenable.io and Nessus; produced risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracked remediation status.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Provided security engineering and infrastructure support for a SaaS FinTech company serving regulated global enterprise clients.
- Administered Microsoft Azure cloud security controls and Azure Active Directory; managed user lifecycle, MFA enforcement, Conditional Access policies, and privileged access.

- Conducted vulnerability assessments and supported ISO 27001 and SOC 2 compliance activities; produced evidence documentation for internal and external audits.
- Managed endpoint security tooling and network security configurations; maintained service availability for business-critical systems.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered over 60 custom KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, reducing high-fidelity false positives by 35 per cent and improving SOC detection coverage across endpoint, identity, and email workloads.
- Built Microsoft Sentinel dashboards and reporting pipelines that reduced manual reporting time by over 60 per cent, providing leadership with real-time visibility into incident trends and rule performance.
- Developed Logic Apps automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating alert enrichment and first-response actions and reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-volume alerts by over 50 per cent.
- Deployed and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR/XDR integrated with Microsoft Sentinel across 8,000-plus endpoints, achieving full endpoint visibility and cross-platform threat correlation.
- Delivered Pentera BAS adversary simulation that validated detection coverage and identified gaps; drove remediation of critical attack paths across Active Directory and Microsoft 365.
- Achieved near-total MFA coverage for 8,000-plus users via Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access, materially reducing identity compromise risk and aligning to Zero Trust principles.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)